Build a Financial Storyboard from Revenue to Net Income

Scenario

Imagine you are an analyst preparing for your company's quarterly review. You have been provided with a financial dataset that includes revenue, expenses, and net income figures. Your task is to create a comprehensive Excel dashboard that visually represents this data. Your primary goal is to build a dynamic waterfall chart and two supporting charts that work together to tell a cohesive financial story.

Learning Objectives

By the end of this assignment, you will be able to:

- Construct a waterfall chart that effectively illustrates the flow of revenue to net income.
- Develop two supporting charts that complement the waterfall chart and enhance the overall narrative.
- Analyze the financial data to draw insights and present findings clearly and engagingly.

Your Tasks

Step 1: Data Preparation

1. **Access the Dataset**: Open the provided financial dataset in Excel. Familiarize yourself with the data structure, including revenue, expenses, and net income.
2. **Clean the Data**: Ensure the data is organized and error-free. Check for any missing values or inconsistencies that may affect your analysis.

Step 2: Create the Waterfall Chart

1. **Insert Waterfall Chart**: Highlight the relevant data for revenue, expenses, and net income. Navigate to the **Insert** tab, select **Waterfall Chart**, and insert it into your worksheet.
2. **Format the Chart**: Adjust the colors to represent positive and negative values clearly. Ensure that the chart accurately reflects the flow from revenue to net income.
3. **Link to Source Data**: Make sure the waterfall chart is linked to your source data so that it updates automatically when changes are made.

Your Tasks

Step 3: Develop Supporting Charts

1. **Choose Supporting Charts**: Select two additional chart types that will complement your waterfall chart. Consider options like:
   - A bar chart showing revenue by category.
   - A line chart illustrating trends in expenses over time.
2. **Insert and Format Supporting Charts**: Create the chosen charts using the relevant data. Format them for clarity, ensuring they are visually appealing and easy to interpret.

Step 4: Build the Dashboard

1. **Arrange Your Charts**: Organize the waterfall chart and supporting charts on a single Excel worksheet to create a cohesive dashboard.
2. **Add Contextual Elements**: Include titles, labels, and any necessary annotations that help explain the charts and overall financial narrative.

Your Tasks

Step 5: Analyze and Reflect

1. **Analyze the Data**: Review the charts and extract key insights. What trends do you observe? How do the expenses impact net income?
2. **Prepare for Presentation**: Be ready to present your dashboard during the quarterly review. Think about the story your data tells and how you can communicate it effectively to your audience.

Submission Output

Upload your completed dashboard as a single PDF file comprising:

1. The dynamic waterfall chart.
2. Two supporting charts.
3. A brief reflection (4–6 sentences) on your findings: What insights did you gain? How do the charts work together to tell a financial story?

Self-Assessment Checklist

- Waterfall chart created and formatted correctly.
- Two supporting charts developed and formatted.
- Charts linked to source data for dynamic updates.
- Dashboard organized and visually appealing.
- Brief reflection documented on insights and narrative.